

MARKET INTELLIGENCE OPPORTUNITY BRIEF

# The Micro-SaaS Market Nobody Is Watching

*What 1,000 revenue-verified TrustMRR listings reveal about an underserved deal-sourcing opportunity*

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Prepared for investor review | Source: TrustMRR, 1,000-listing snapshot, frozen 30 Jul 2026 | 1 Aug 2026

# Every Month, Thousands of Founders Quietly Build Real Revenue

Small, founder-run software businesses now generate real, billing-verified revenue through Stripe, RevenueCat, and similar providers. Directories like TrustMRR aggregate this into public listings — a raw feed on where money is actually being made in software, and which of those businesses are for sale.

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**The question this brief answers:** *is there a viable market-intelligence or deal-sourcing product to be built on top of this data?*

**1,000**

software businesses analyzed

**\$133.8M**

combined 12-month revenue in the snapshot

# But Buying Into This Market Means Flying Blind

01

## Fragmented visibility

Revenue-verified listings are scattered across TrustMRR, Acquire, and founder X threads — no consolidated, queryable view exists.

02

## No systematic screening

Buyers browse listings manually today. There's no way to filter the market by category, growth, multiple, or geography at scale.

03

## Pricing opacity

Revenue multiples on comparable listings range from 0.0x to over 300x in this dataset alone — with no reference point for what's fair.

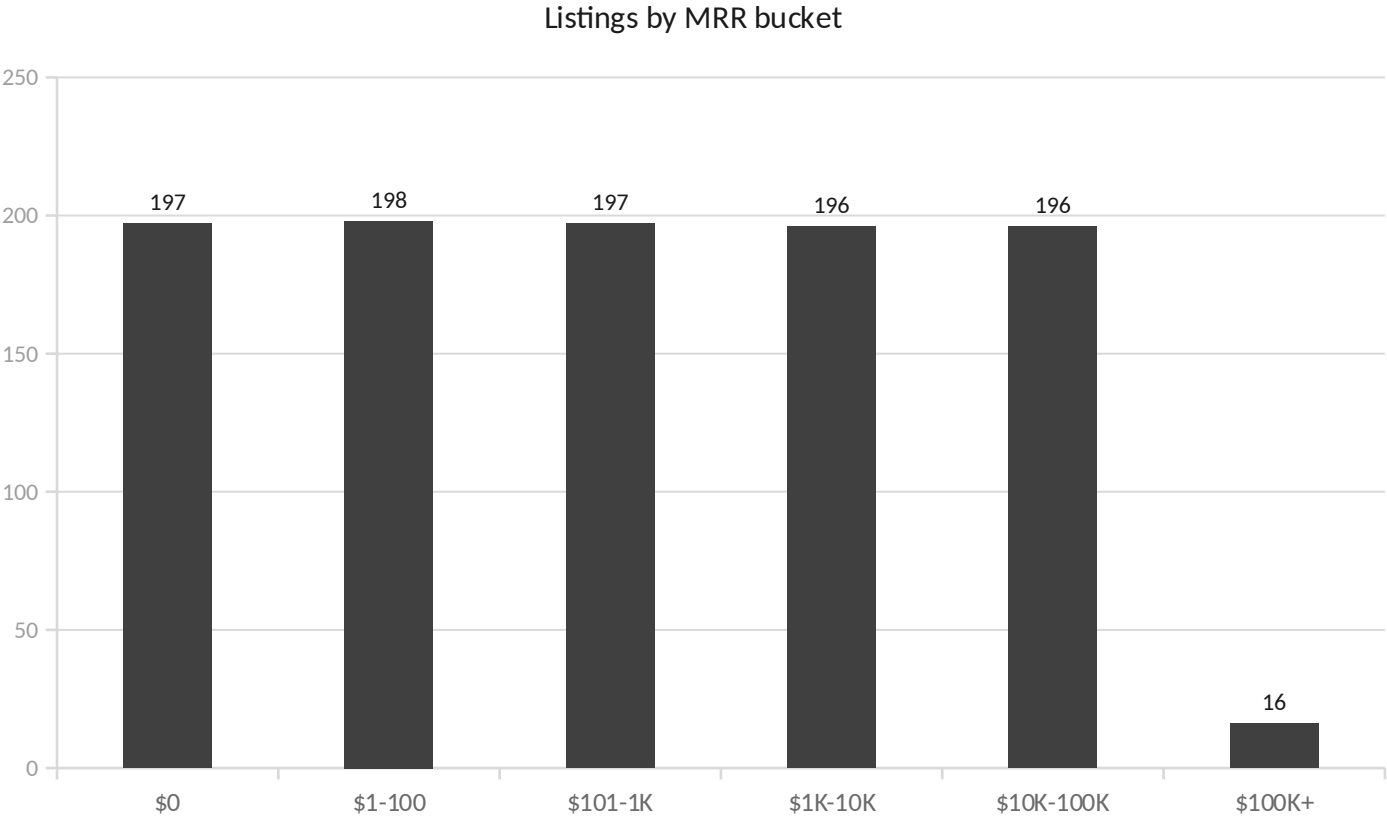
04

## Anonymous supply

A meaningful share of sellers list under a placeholder name. Today that's a dead end for a buyer — it should be a structured signal instead.

# The Data Tells a Long-Tail Story

Median monthly recurring revenue is \$282. Mean MRR is \$13,472. That gap only happens in a market with a long tail.



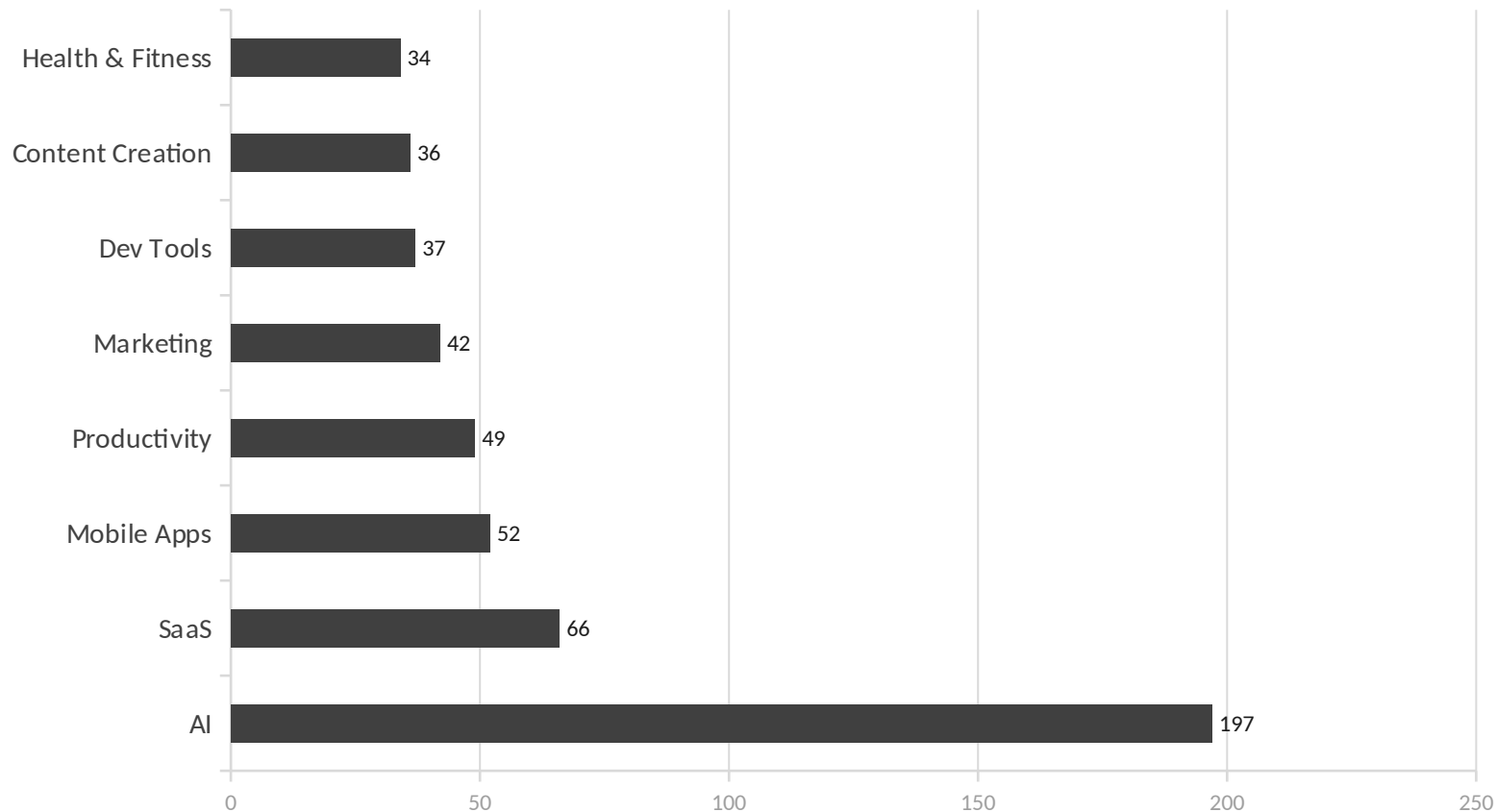
## WHAT THIS TELLS US

Only 16 listings — 1.6% of the dataset — clear \$100K in monthly recurring revenue. Every other bucket holds roughly 195-198 listings apiece.

This is the segment a screening tool most needs to surface fast: the rare, high-value listings hiding in a sea of near-zero-revenue businesses that manual browsing can't sort through.

# Where the Money Actually Lives

*AI is not a niche in this market. It's close to the center of it.*



**13.8%**

of all trailing 12-month revenue in the dataset  
comes from AI listings alone (\$18.4M of \$133.8M)

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**\$446 vs. \$282**

median MRR for AI listings vs. the dataset-wide  
median

# We Put Four Hard Questions to the Data

## Q1

### Where is the money actually concentrated?

AI listings generated \$18.4M of the dataset's \$133.8M in trailing 12-month revenue, with a median MRR of \$446 — well above the \$282 dataset-wide median.

A sourcing product should weight coverage and comps toward AI and Marketing first, not spread evenly across 15+ categories.

## Q2

### What does a realistic entry-level deal look like?

Among on-sale listings priced at \$50,000 or less with positive MRR (114 of 262 on-sale listings), the median revenue multiple is 2.35x and median MRR is \$210.

This is the volume end of the market — too small for institutional buyers, but exactly where a screening tool creates the most value.

## ...And Two More That Decide Whether This Is Investable

### Q3

**Do revenue multiples actually vary in a usable way?**

Yes. SaaS and Dev Tools deals sell at the lowest multiples (1.2x-1.35x median), while Education and Marketing command the highest (3.7x-3.95x). AI sits mid-to-high at 3.15x.

This is the clearest evidence that category-level pricing comps are learnable — and would be a defensible, core feature of any pricing tool.

### Q4

**Does anonymity hide the best deals or the weakest?**

Neither uniformly — but anonymous ('Stealth Company') listings skew toward higher per-listing revenue than named ones.

A sourcing tool can't simply filter anonymous sellers out without discarding some of the most attractive deal flow. It needs to rank them by verified revenue and growth instead of founder brand.

# The Gap in the Data Is the Opportunity

*Every weakness below is also a feature nobody has built yet.*

| Gap                  | Today                       | Why it's an opportunity                                                                          |
|----------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Traffic data         | Missing for 82% of listings | An obvious enrichment layer to build and sell on top of the raw feed.                            |
| Category tagging     | Missing for 27% of listings | Auto-classification is a clear, buildable wedge — not a dead end.                                |
| Revenue verification | 100% self-reported          | Independent verification against billing accounts is the trust layer that makes this defensible. |
| Point-in-time only   | One frozen snapshot         | Tracking listings over time turns a static directory into real growth and churn signal.          |

# Proceed to a Scoped Pilot — Not a Full Build

The signal is real: category-level pricing patterns are learnable, revenue is concentrated enough to prioritize coverage, and the entry-level segment (\$50K and under) is large enough — 114+ comparable listings in a 1,000-row sample — to be worth systematizing.

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**Before committing further capital, validate two things:** (1) whether self-reported revenue can be verified at reasonable cost, and (2) whether category-level pricing comps hold on a larger sample than this 1,000-row snapshot.

## IF BOTH HOLD:

A defensible screening and comps product for an underserved, high-volume segment of the software M&A market.

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## IF THEY DON'T:

Walk away before building — a thin wrapper around someone else's directory is not a defensible business.